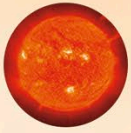
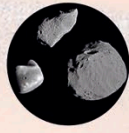


What is a planet?

To qualify as a planet, an object has to meet these conditions.



It must be in **orbit around a star**, just as the Earth orbits the Sun.



Its orbit must be **cleared of other objects** (which Pluto's is not).



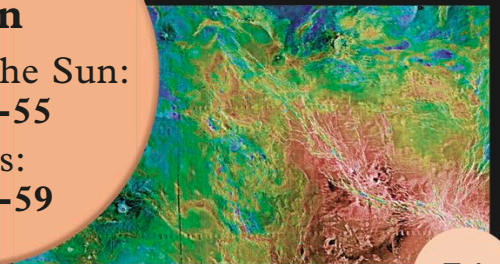
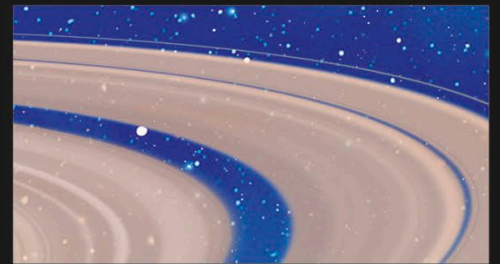
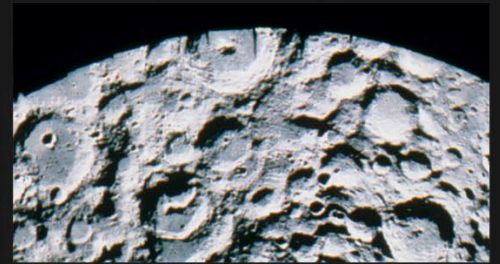
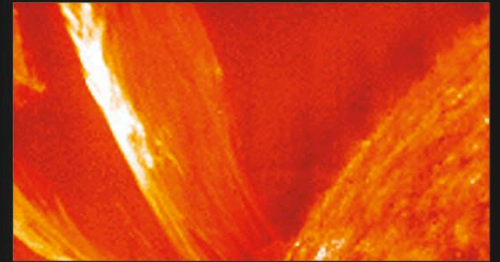
It must be **large enough** for its gravity to make it round.



It must **not be a satellite** (as, for example, the Moon is a satellite of the Earth).

Picture detective

Look through the Solar System section and see if you can identify the pictures below.



Saturn

Every 15 years, Saturn appears sideways to us and the rings seem to disappear.

Uranus

Neptune

Turn and learn

Eclipse of the Sun:

pp. 54-55

Venus:

pp. 58-59